Placeholder University

Placeholder Doctoral School
Information Sciences & Technologies

Habilitation to Supervise Research

Presented by:
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A Placeholder Title for a Placeholder Manuscript

Defended publicly on **November 12th, 2026** before the jury composed of:

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Foreword

TL; DR

This chapter is an unnumbered one, obtained with `\chapter*[label]{Title}`. Use it for a foreword, for the Acknowledgements that follow, or for anything that should not carry a chapter number. Such a chapter still takes a label, and is referred to exactly like a numbered one: `\nameref{foreword}` gives Foreword.

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How to Read This Document

This document is meant to be read in its PDF version, using a viewer able to display tooltips (*e.g.,* Acrobat, Evince, Overleaf). Hovering an acronym or a citation then shows a short description, without having to jump to the end of the document.

- **Acronyms** — Every acronym is defined once in `acronyms.tex`, and the ones this document uses are recalled in the list of Acronyms. In the text, `\acro{ai}` gives AI, `\acrofull{ai}` gives Artificial Intelligence (AI), and `\acroname{ai}` gives Artificial Intelligence.
- **References** — Citations to my own work carry a code indicating the type of publication, *e.g.,* [J_3] for a **J**ournal or [C_5] for a **C**onference. External references appear like [Ipsum *et al.*, 1998], and online resources like [Placeholder].
- **Cross-references** — Labels are declared as an optional argument of the sectioning command or environment, and recalled with `\nameref`. For instance, `\nameref{past}` gives Chapter II, and `\nameref{example_figure}` gives Figure 2. Unnumbered chapters are recalled by their title rather than by a number, which also applies to the two chapters closing the document: `\nameref{bibliography}` gives Bibliography, and `\nameref{glossary}` gives Acronyms.

The template used for this document is available at [GitHub], under the GNU GPL v3. Feel free to reuse it, and to replace all the placeholder text you find here.

Acknowledgements

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Unlike the Foreword, this chapter has no section at all, which is perfectly fine: an unnumbered chapter behaves as a regular one, minus the number and the mini table of contents.

Chapter I

Introduction

The optional fourth argument of \chapter is a short text displayed on the chapter page, above the mini table of contents.

Use it to announce what the chapter contains, and to point to its sections, *e.g.,* Section I.1 and Section I.3.

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I.1 Context

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Duis aute irure dolor in reprehenderit in voluptate velit esse cillum dolore eu fugiat nulla pariatur. Excepteur sint occaecat cupidatat non proident, sunt in culpa qui officia deserunt mollit anim id est laborum.

Challenge 1 Stating the problem in one sentence

Boxes are created with `\begin{boxenv}[label]{Type}[Title]`. The type is free: a counter is created automatically for each distinct type, so this one is Challenge 1. Boxes are also breakable, so a long one will span several pages without any special care.

I.2 Contributions

My contributions to this placeholder topic are summarized below, and detailed in Chapter II.

- A placeholder method for placeholder data, published in [J_3].
- A placeholder analysis of placeholder models, published in [C_5].
- A placeholder application to a placeholder use case, published in [B_2].

I.3 Outline

Chapter II summarizes my past activities, and Chapter III presents the directions I intend to follow. Additional material is provided in Appendix A, and the document closes on the Bibliography and the list of Acronyms. These two chapters are unnumbered, just like the Foreword and the Acknowledgements opening the document, and are therefore recalled by their title rather than by a number.

Chapter II

Overview of Past Activities

This chapter is the showcase one: it demonstrates the figures, tables, equations, boxes and cross-references provided by the template.

All the text is placeholder text, so do not look for any meaning in it. Replace it with a summary of your own activities.

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II.1 A First Research Topic

II.1.1 Context

Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet, consectetur adipiscing elit [Ipsum *et al.*, 1998]. Sed do eiusmod tempor incididunt ut labore et dolore magna aliqua, as later formalized in [Tempor *et al.*, 2009] and revisited by [Amet *et al.*, 2017]. My own contributions on this topic are [T1], [J3] and [C5].

Definition 1 Placeholder object

A *placeholder object* is any object that carries no meaning, and only exists to occupy the space where a real one will eventually be written. Note that the counter of this box is independent from the one of Challenge 1, since the types differ.

Placeholder objects satisfy the property stated in Theorem 1, whose proof is immediate.

Theorem 1 Conservation of placeholders

Let $\mathcal{P}$ be a set of placeholder objects, and f a placeholder map. Then $f(\mathcal{P})$ is a set of placeholder objects.

Proof of Theorem 1

By definition, a placeholder object carries no meaning. Applying a placeholder map to a meaningless object cannot create meaning, hence the result. □

II.1.2 Method

The overall pipeline is sketched in Figure 1: a placeholder object, as introduced in Definition 1, is fed to a placeholder model that produces a placeholder output. The placeholder loss we minimize is given in Equation 1, where $\boldsymbol{x}$ denotes an input, $\boldsymbol{y}$ its target, and θ the parameters of the model.

$$\mathcal{L}(\theta) = \frac{1}{N} \sum_{i=1}^{N} \| f_\theta(\boldsymbol{x}_i) - \boldsymbol{y}_i \|_2^2 + \lambda \| \theta \|_2^2 \tag{1}$$

Note that equations, figures and tables are numbered continuously across the whole document, and not per chapter. This is on purpose: it makes cross-references such as Equation 1 unambiguous.

Run-in headings Below `\subsubsection`, two run-in levels are available. This one is a `\paragraph`: bold, in the colour of the titles, and referable like any other level through Run-in headings.

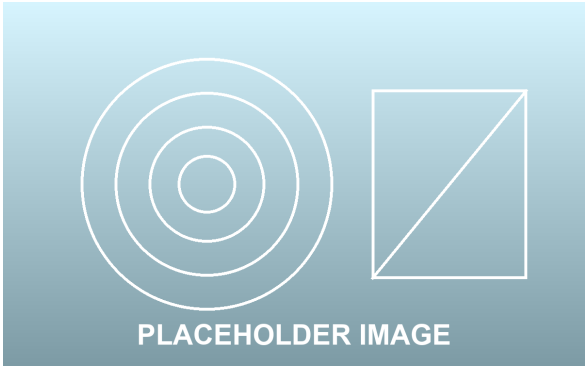
One level deeper A `\subparagraph` is the same run-in separator in the same colour, but in the normal font weight. Neither level is numbered, and neither appears in the table of contents.



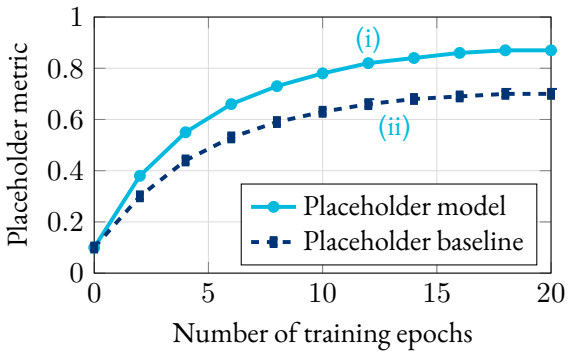
Figure 1 The pipeline used throughout this placeholder chapter. A figure is declared with `\begin{figure}[label]{caption}`, and takes no placement specifier: the caption is the second, mandatory argument.

II.1.3 Results

Results are reported in Figure 2, and summarized in Table 1. As expected, the placeholder model in Figure 2 (b) outperforms the placeholder baseline, which is exactly what a placeholder result is supposed to do.



(a) A raster image, included with the usual `\includegraphics`.



(b) A vector figure, generated by a script and included with `\input`. (i) The placeholder model; (ii) The placeholder baseline. Both markers are placed with `\labeledText[label]{text}`, and recalled here with `\nameref`.

Figure 2 A figure made of several subfigures. Subfigures take a label, a width, and a caption, and can be referred to individually, as in (a), or as a whole through Figure 2.

II.2 Collaborations

Beyond Section II.1, I contributed to a few placeholder collaborations, listed below. CNNs were involved in most of them, which is a convenient excuse to demonstrate a variation: `cnn_plural` carries no `long` field and names `cnn` in its `alt` field, so the list of Acronyms holds no line of its own for it. Hovering it still shows Convolutional Neural Networks, and clicking it leads to the CNN entry.

Dataset	Baseline	Placeholder model
Placeholder-A	0.70 ± 0.02	$\mathbf{0.87 \pm 0.01}$
Placeholder-B	0.61 ± 0.03	$\mathbf{0.79 \pm 0.02}$
Placeholder-C	0.55 ± 0.04	$\mathbf{0.68 \pm 0.03}$

Table 1 Placeholder results, on placeholder datasets. Tables follow the same convention as figures: `\begin{table}[label]{caption}`.

[B2] Firstname Lastname, Second Coauthor (2019). **"Consectetur Adipiscing Elit: A Placeholder Book Chapter"**. *Handbook of Placeholder Methods (pp. 101–128), Placeholder Press*

A starred box, `boxenv*`, is not numbered. This makes it convenient to summarize a publication: the title of the box is the citation, and its subtitle the full reference. Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet, consectetur adipiscing elit, sed do eiusmod tempor incididunt.

[W6] Fourth Student, Firstname Lastname (2023). **"Duis Aute Irure: Preliminary Placeholder Results"**. *Workshop on Placeholder Directions*

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Online resources can be cited the same way, *e.g.*, [Placeholder], and are gathered in their own section of the Bibliography.

Chapter III

Future Work & Directions

A short chapter, to show that a chapter does not have to be long.

It presents the directions I intend to follow after the work summarized in Chapter II.

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III.1 Short Term

Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet, consectetur adipiscing elit, sed do eiusmod tempor incididunt ut labore et dolore magna aliqua. This direction directly extends [P_7], and relies on the placeholder loss of Equation 1.

Challenge 2 Making placeholders scale

The main obstacle is the cost of placeholder training, which grows with the number of placeholder objects. Note that this box continues the counter started by Challenge 1, since both share the same type.

III.2 Long Term

Ut enim ad minim veniam, quis nostrud exercitation ullamco laboris nisi ut aliquip ex ea commodo consequat. In the long run, I would like to address Challenge 2 by combining the results of Section II.1.3 with the SOTA approaches of [Amet *et al.*, 2017].

- A first placeholder direction, on placeholder data.
- A second placeholder direction, on placeholder models.
- A third placeholder direction, on placeholder applications.

Appendix A

Curriculum Vitæ

An appendix behaves exactly like a chapter, except that it is numbered as an appendix and appears under a dedicated entry in the table of contents.

This one shows the two-column layout used throughout the template for tabular material.

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A.1 General Information

Name	Firstname Lastname
Born	October 3rd, 1988
Nationality	Placeholder
Links	
Email	firstname.lastname@example.org

Note the `\date` command: it takes an ISO date and formats it according to the language of the document.

A.2 Education & Positions

2010 – 2015	PhD in Placeholder Science Placeholder Laboratory, Placeholder University Dissertation: [T1]
2015 – 2017	Postdoctoral researcher Placeholder Institute
Since 2017	Associate professor Placeholder Laboratory, Placeholder University

A.3 Supervision

A.3.1 PhD Students

As Associate Professor

Fourth Student

Period	2021 – 2024 (36 months)
Defended	November 29th, 2024
Share	50%
Funding	Placeholder Foundation
Subject	*"A Placeholder Title for a Placeholder Thesis"*
Publications	[W6; P7]

⋮

Fifth Student

Period	Since 2024 (in progress)
Share	33%
Funding	Placeholder Region (*"Placeholder"* grant)
Subject	Yet another placeholder subject

A.3.2 Interns

As Associate Professor

Second Coauthor

Period	2022 (6 months)
Level	MSc 2
Share	100%
Subject	*"Another Placeholder Topic"*

As Postdoctoral Researcher

Third Contributor

Period	2016 (4 months)
Level	MSc 1
Share	50%
Subject	A placeholder internship topic

As PhD Student

First Placeholder

Period	2014 (3 months)
Level	BSc 3
Share	100%
Subject	The very first placeholder internship

A.4 Teaching

Since 2017	*"Introduction to Machine Learning"* MSc 1, 30h/year
Since 2019	*"Placeholder Programming"* MSc 2, 45h/year

Bibliography

References I Contributed To

PhD Theses

[T_1 | Lastname, 2015]

10, 16

Firstname Lastname (2015). **"Lorem Ipsum Dolor Sit Amet: A Placeholder Doctoral Dissertation"**. *Placeholder University (PhD).*

Book Chapters

[B_2 | Lastname *et al.*, 2019]

8, 12

Firstname Lastname, Second Coauthor (2019). **"Consectetur Adipiscing Elit: A Placeholder Book Chapter"**. *Handbook of Placeholder Methods (pp. 101–128), Placeholder Press.*

Journals

[J_3 | Lastname *et al.*, 2021]

3, 8, 10

Firstname Lastname, Second Coauthor, Third Contributor (2021). **"Sed Do Eiusmod Tempor: Learning Placeholder Representations with CNNs"**. *Journal of Placeholder Research (vol. 12, nb. 3, pp. 42–58).*

[J_4 | Coauthor *et al.*, 2024]

Second Coauthor, Firstname Lastname (2024). **"Ut Enim Ad Minim Veniam: Scaling Placeholder Models on a Single GPU"**. *Transactions on Placeholder Systems (vol. 7, pp. 1–21).*

Conferences

[C_5 | Lastname *et al.*, 2022]

3, 8, 10

Firstname Lastname, Third Contributor (2022). **"Quis Nostrud Exercitation: A Placeholder Approach to Placeholder Problems"**. *14th International Conference on Placeholder Science (pp. 77–86).*

Workshops

[W$_6$ | Student *et al.*, 2023]
12, 16

Fourth Student, Firstname Lastname (2023). **"Duis Aute Irure: Preliminary Placeholder Results"**. *Workshop on Placeholder Directions*.

Preprints

[P$_7$ | Lastname *et al.*, 2025]
14, 16

Firstname Lastname, Fourth Student (2025). **"Excepteur Sint Occaecat: Towards Placeholder Foundation Models"**. *Placeholder Preprint Server*.

Other References

[Amet *et al.*, 2017]
— 10, 14

Consectetur Amet, Adipiscing Elit (2017). **"Seminal Placeholder Architectures for Structured Data"**. *31st Conference on Placeholder Systems (pp. 5998–6008)*.

[Ipsum *et al.*, 1998]
— 3, 8, 10

Lorem Ipsum, Sit Dolor (1998). **"A Foundational Placeholder Study of Nothing in Particular"**. *Proceedings of the Placeholder Society (vol. 3, nb. 2, pp. 17–29)*.

[Tempor *et al.*, 2009]
— 8, 10

Eiusmod Tempor, Ut Labore (2009). **"The Elements of Placeholder Learning"**. *Placeholder Academic Publishing*.

Online Resources

[GitHub]
August 19th, 2026
3

Bastien Pasdeloup. **"A LaTeX Template for HDR and PhD Manuscripts"**. *GitHub*.

[Placeholder]
August 19th, 2026
3, 12

"A Placeholder Online Resource". *Placeholder Organization*.

Acronyms

AI	**A**rtificial **I**ntelligence
BSc	**B**achelor of **Sc**ience
CNN	**C**onvolutional **N**eural **N**etwork
GNU	**GNU**'s **N**ot **U**nix
GPL	**G**eneral **P**ublic **L**icense
GPU	**G**raphics **P**rocessing **U**nit
HDR	**H**abilitation à **D**iriger des **R**echerches
ML	**M**achine **L**earning
MSc	**M**aster of **Sc**ience
PDF	**P**ortable **D**ocument **F**ormat
PhD	**Ph**ilosophiæ **D**octor
SOTA	**S**tate **O**f **T**he **A**rt

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